

TAB 7



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-243-25/26, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 12/16/2025

In Control: Communications, Engagement & Collaboration

Community Challenge Grant 2.0 - Renewal to Launch A New Three-Year Cycle

Division of Communications, Engagement & Collaboration

Brief Description:

(Community Challenge Grant 2.0 - Renewal to Launch A New Three-Year Cycle). Recommends approval of the Community Challenge Grant 2.0 program and authorization to award a total of \$2,100,000 in individual Community Challenge grants over a three-year period, to tax-exempt community organizations to provide high quality enrichment activities outside of the school and school day to Los Angeles Unified District students enrolled in high need schools.

Action Proposed:

Approve the renewal of the Community Challenge Grant program (Community Challenge Grant 2.0) for a new three-year term, from January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2029, and authorize the award of individual Community Challenge grants in the range of \$25,000-\$50,000 to tax-exempt community organizations, up to a total amount of \$2,100,000.

Background:

On November 14, 2023, in Board Report 087-23/24, the Board authorized the Procurement Services Division to negotiate and award a total of \$2 million in individual Community Challenge grants to tax-exempt community organizations over a three-year period, to provide high-quality after-school enrichment activities and services to District students. The Division of Communications, Engagement & Collaboration was tasked with the management of outreach activities and convening central office teams to assess Community Challenge grant applications.

A total of 23 grantees provided services for LAUSD students during SY 2024-25, impacting over 700 students and over 80 parents. We anticipate serving over 1,300 students and over 200 parents total within the initial round (Community Challenge Grant 1.0).

In year one of the first round (1.0), grantees implemented innovative programming designed to help students boost literacy, feel a stronger sense of belonging, apply to college, and develop new skills. Families benefited from workshops that prepared them to support their child's pathway to college. Partners have responded swiftly to urgent needs amid recent immigration actions, and many have also participated in District-led initiatives such as We Are One and Principal for a Day.

Expected Outcomes:

Adoption of the renewal of the Community Challenge Grant 2.0 will allow Los Angeles Unified to expand enrichment support services to students and families at grantee facilities through a second grant cycle that will allow additional grantees to apply. Prior grantees will be invited to reapply. Selected grant recipients will be presented for Board ratification, as they were in the prior round.

File #: Rep-243-25/26, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 12/16/2025

In Control: Communications, Engagement & Collaboration

Board Options and Consequences:

Approval of this renewal of the Community Challenge Grant 2.0 will: authorize the District to solicit applications for a new grant cycle; and award a total of \$2.1 million in individual Community Challenge grants to tax exempt community organizations within a three-year period to provide additional enrichment opportunities for students and parents outside of the instructional day and in trusted community spaces.

If this program is not renewed, Los Angeles Unified will eliminate one opportunity to engage community organizations that have not historically worked directly with the District to provide services.

Policy Implications:

Los Angeles Unified will engage with tax-exempt organizations via grant agreements that will allow enrichment services aligned with the District's Strategic Plan to be provided off school campuses.

Budget Impact:

The total budget of \$2.1 million in Unrestricted General Funds will allow approximately 21-24 tax-exempt organizations to be awarded \$25,000 to \$50,000 in grant funds to provide enrichment services to students and parents after school and at their sites. The entire \$2.1 million in approved funds are passed through the District to the grantees. Costs associated with staffing, management, overhead and oversight of the grant program are all absorbed by the Office of Development & Civic Engagement. These activities currently utilize approximately 15% of available staffing resources within this Office.

Student Impact:

The proposed renewal of the program will support data-informed student and parent needs in academics, wellness, college-readiness, and parent engagement. The program will serve approximately 600-1000 students each school year, which represents grant funding utilization of approximately \$1,050- \$1,750 per student per annum.

Equity Impact:

The Community Challenge Grant 2.0 will give preference to tax-exempt organizations that serve Priority School and High and Highest Need SENI 2.0 school communities. In addition, organizations that have a demonstrated track record of trust and engagement with those communities will also be given preference.

Issues and Analysis:

Approval of the program is time sensitive in order to allow for the solicitation of applications, ratification of grant agreements, and execution of grant agreements to be established before May 2026, so that services can be provided as early as Summer 2026.

Attachments:

Exhibit A - Community Challenge Grant Program Overview

Submitted:

11/24/25

File #: Rep-243-25/26, Version: 1
In Control: Communications, Engagement & Collaboration

Agenda Date: 12/16/2025

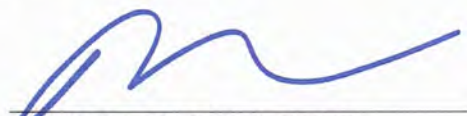
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:

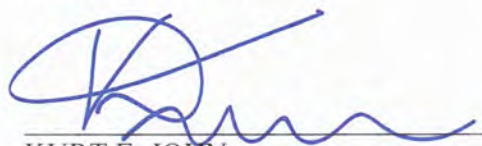

JANA CARTER
Chief
Division of Communications,
Engagement & Collaboration

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

REVIEWED BY:


KURT E. JOHN
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

EXHIBIT A

COMMUNITY CHALLENGE GRANT PROGRAM OVERVIEW

As a strategy to increase enrichment services to students and engagement within the Los Angeles community, the District is providing tax-exempt organizations an opportunity to apply for grants in the range of \$25,000 to \$50,000 and extend their services for up to one year to provide support services that meet the academic and social-emotional growth of students and their families. Services can include, but are not limited to tutoring, mentoring, classes in theater, dance, music, service learning opportunities, field trips to colleges and universities, and family workshops and educational events.

The Office of Development and Civic Engagement will be responsible for the management of outreach activities and convening central office teams to assess Community Challenge grant applications, which will be accepted by a specified deadline. The Office will work with Procurement, Finance, Risk Management, and Division of Instruction to issue grant awards, create reports, and implement the program. The Office of Development and Civic Engagement will launch a solicitation for grant applications this winter and establish a committee of internal reviewers to review and recommend grantee recipients. Procurement will submit the selected grant recipients' contracts for Board ratification.

Grant applications will be evaluated on the following criteria:

- Qualification and experience serving high need communities
- Experience working directly with LAUSD (higher weight given to those with less experience)
- Proposal of Services
- Operations and Community Relations
- Innovation and Outcomes

The grant program intends to support 21-24 existing tax-exempt organizations engaged in supporting 600-1,200 students and their families. The program will engage with tax-exempt community-based organizations that do not currently have bench contracts with the District to provide direct services at their site in the L.A. County region. Programs must be offered outside of the instructional day and off LA Unified school grounds. In addition, preference is given to organizations that serve District Tier III Priority Schools communities, High & Highest Need school communities based on the SENI 2.0 Index and/or English Learner families. Additionally, organizations must have pre-existing and secular programming. Organizations will need to meet the District's liability insurance and fingerprinting requirements based on the type of services being provided. Grantees must provide a mid-year report that demonstrates the impact of the services to receive further funding installments. Organizations must also provide an end-of-year report to assess the impact of programming.

Below are the expected outcomes the grants will achieve.

Academics	Social Emotional	Family Engagement	College & Career Readiness
Improve literacy Improve numeracy skills Increase STEAM educational opportunities Increase tutoring participation	Grow in social-emotional competencies Promote active lifestyles Promote healthy nutrition Increase mentorship	Increase Parent Portal usage Amplify District resources and messaging Provide additional educational resources	Increase A-G completion rates Increase support with financial aid Provide internship opportunities Increase career exposure including CTE pathways

The Community Challenge Grants align with the following Local Control and Accountability Plan Goals and the LAUSD Strategic Plan:

- Academic Excellence
- Joy and Wellness
- Engagement and Collaboration
- English Learner Supports
- Black Student Achievement Plan